The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY · KEY NUMBERS · FROM THE INBOX · ON X · CYCLE TRACKER · EVENTS

KOSPI (FRI FINAL)
5,059.69 −6.02% (corrects No. 31 near-close); low 4,911.28 (−8.78%); Samsung ₩188,700 (−6.35%) · SK hynix ₩1,132,000 (−10.44%); foreigners −₩2.77T · Yonhap / Korea Herald

MICRON (FRI CLOSE)
$690.00 +5.12% rebound after Thu rout; Sandisk $835.06 (+3.55%); SOX 9,390.25 (+4.21%); LRCX $200.44 (+8.23%) · Exa, Motley Fool

LEAD STORY

FOUNDRY · MEMORY · SPLIT TAPE

TSMC Charts 3D DRAM for Nvidia — While Seoul Prints the Full Friday Damage

Sources tell The Information TSMC has begun early plans for 3D DRAM at Nvidia's request, led by Hsu Kuo-chin — no timeline, no capex. US chips rebounded Friday (MU $690 / +5.12%, SOX +4.21%) while Korea's official close confirmed the plunge: KOSPI 5,059.69 (−6.02%), Samsung ₩188,700, SK hynix ₩1,132,000. Spot DDR5 still $60.167 (−0.82%); DDR4 edged to $80.815 (−1.06%).

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:20 IST Saturday (UTC+2) · US Friday closes · Korea Friday FINAL · Japan Friday · Spot TrendForce Nov 6 18:10 GMT+8 · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · FRIDAY ASIA FINAL · FRIDAY US · SPOT

ASIA, FRIDAY FINAL

KOSPI, Fri FINAL	**5,059.69 (−6.02%)**
Samsung, Fri FINAL	**₩188,700 (−6.35%)**
SK hynix, Fri FINAL	**₩1,132,000 (−10.44%)**
USD/KRW (Fri 15:30 KST)	**1,356.6**
Nikkei 225	**57,434.77 (−5.96%)**
Foreigners (Korea Fri)	**−₩2.77T**

US FRIDAY CLOSES AND SPOT

Micron	**$690.00 (+5.12%)**
Sandisk	**$835.06 (+3.55%)**
SOX	**9,390.25 (+4.21%)**
Lam Research	**$200.44 (+8.23%)**
DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.17 (−0.82%)**
DDR4 16Gb spot	**$80.82 (−1.06%)**
512Gb TLC wafer spot	**$16.15 (−4.33% w/w)**

What this shows: the split tape — US Friday rebound after Thursday's rout vs Asia Friday FINAL plunge (corrects No. 31's near-close). Korea: KOSPI 5,059.69 (−6.02%) not 5,042.25; Samsung ₩188,700 not ₩188,500; SK hynix ₩1,132,000 not ₩1,129,000; foreigners −₩2.77T (Yonhap / Korea Herald / Hani). Japan Nikkei −5.96%. Spot as of Nov 6, 18:10 GMT+8: DDR5 unchanged vs No. 31; DDR4 slightly softer. Wafer weekly carry from Nov 4 Insights. Sources: Yonhap, Korea Herald, Japan Times, Exa, Motley Fool, Yahoo, TrendForce.

The Information (Qianer Liu), via Reuters and other wraps, reports that TSMC has started charting plans for **3D DRAM** at the request of Nvidia, its largest customer. The effort is led by Hsu Kuo-chin, vice president for advanced packaging. Options under discussion include building new fabs or acquiring/converting an existing plant. There is **no timeline, no capex decision, and no production date**. TSMC and Nvidia did not immediately comment. Plans-only — a long-dated competitive option for memory incumbents, not near-term supply relief (The Information / Reuters via Investing.com / Techmeme / The Verge) REPORT.

Markets told two stories on Friday. In New York, chips bounced after Thursday's wipeout: Micron closed at $690.00 (+5.12%), Sandisk $835.06 (+3.55%), Lam Research $200.44 (+8.23%), and the PHLX SOX rose 4.21% to 9,390.25. The Nasdaq Composite gained 1.09%. Bargain-hunting after Thursday's SOX −12.25% / MU −17.46% / SNDK −22.26% — still far below Wednesday levels (Motley Fool; Exa).

In Asia, Friday's **official closes** confirmed the damage and correct No. 31's near-close prints. KOSPI finished at **5,059.69 (−6.02%)** — not the provisional 5,042.25 (−6.34%). Samsung closed at **₩188,700 (−6.35%)**; SK hynix at **₩1,132,000 (−10.44%)**. The session low was 4,911.28 (−8.78%) after a Level-1 circuit breaker early. Foreigners net sold ₩2.77 trillion (SK hynix alone −₩1.924T). The won settled at ₩1,356.6 per dollar. Two-day wipeout: Samsung −13.44% / SK hynix −18.91% (Yonhap / Korea Herald). Tokyo's Nikkei 225 fell 5.96% to 57,434.77 — its third-largest point drop on record (Japan Times).

Spot DRAM did not break lower again on DDR5: the 16Gb print stayed at **$60.167 (−0.82%)** as of Nov 6, 18:10 GMT+8 — unchanged from No. 31's morning print. DDR4 16Gb edged to **$80.815 (−1.06%)** from $80.938. The 512Gb TLC wafer weekly remains $16.152 (−4.33% w/w) from Nov 4 Insights.

Our call: late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028 — unchanged on supply fundamentals. Policy and sentiment risk still elevated (Asia Friday FINAL confirms; US Friday bounce ≠ cycle turn). DDR5 spot flat vs No. 31; DDR4 slightly softer. TSMC 3D DRAM is a long-dated option, not near-term supply.

CYCLE SIGNAL: SPLIT TAPE; PHYSICAL TIGHTNESS INTACT

MARKETS · US FRIDAY

Chip Stocks Rebound After Thursday's Rout

Bargain-hunting lifted semiconductors on Friday after Thursday's midterm/AI-regulation wipeout. Micron rose 5.12% to $690.00 (open $708.35, high $724.80); Sandisk +3.55% to $835.06; Lam Research +8.23% to $200.44; Applied Materials +4.22%; KLA +6.69%. The PHLX SOX closed at 9,390.25 (+4.21%). Western Digital lagged (−1.44%). Motley Fool framed the bounce against still-cited FY27–28 supply tightness — a partial recovery only; Micron remains well below Wednesday's $795 area (Motley Fool, Nov 6; Exa).

NAND · CHINA · CAPEX

YMTC Targets 60–70% Local Tools for a Fourth Fab

Reuters, citing people familiar, says China's YMTC plans to source 60–70% of equipment locally for a planned fourth Wuhan factory aimed at 300-layer-plus data-center NAND, up from about 50% at its third fab. Construction is expected to begin next year; no orders have been placed. Localization color — not a near-term supply increment (Reuters via Investing.com / Techmeme) REPORT.

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE NOV 6, 08:15 IST

NEW **Wood: AI-capex peak case.** Markets signaling unwillingness to fund AI; watch AI credit spreads/CDS; neo-cloud rental strong at 1y but little desire to lock longer; circular financing / SPV private-credit risk flagged; Democrat admin may be less "TBTF." Jefferies GREED & fear (Nov 6)

NEW **Menon: too early to bottom-fish.** Midterm blue-wave → DC regulation fear; inventory/price correction risk if DC go-lives slip; DDR5 spot can feel pressure with PC/smartphone weak. HBM disaggregate from compute discussed for **2028–29** (was 2030+). Pref IFX / Nokia / ams OSRAM / Aixtron. Jefferies Semi-Important Stuff (Nov 6)

NEW **TrendForce: 14× HBM / 3.2TB XPU.** OCP Summit color — hierarchy beyond HBM as KV-cache/agent contexts grow; Nallasway XPU module cites 3.2TB LPDDR5X via SerDes; SK hynix dedicated memory rack + NAND beside GPU. TrendForce Insights (Nov 6)

ON X · SINCE FRI ~08:00 · IST

@JonahLupton · Nov 6 22:09
SK hynix DRAM/HBM demand secured through 2029 at/near record prices & margins, yet stock ~2× 2027 EPS (−56% from highs); argues LTAs lock profits.
x.com/…/2118797900251828600

@pequityresearch · Nov 6 19:00
Samsung / SK hynix see limited hit from U.S. data-center curbs: chips for builds underway still produced; LTAs keep demand — "full restaurant."
x.com/…/2118750261519012051

@SemiconductorsX · Nov 6 13:52
HBM surplus vanishing: +89% (2024) → +51% → +22% → +2% (2027); demand ~+80% vs supply ~+50% in 2027.
x.com/…/2118672887569920466

@jukan05 · Nov 6 13:32
KYEC cut Q4 guidance on delays to a major GPU believed to be NVIDIA Rubin, tied to HBM4 yield issues at a memory supplier. UNCONFIRMED
x.com/…/2118667945455001937

@damnang2 · Nov 6 21:40
Industry chatter: The Information's "3D DRAM" may be oxide-semiconductor eDRAM (SRAM replace), not TSMC entering commodity DRAM.
UNCONFIRMED
x.com/…/2118790554863734991

@LiDaosen · Nov 7 02:45
Monograph "The Non-Fungible Die": custom HBM4 base dies / 3× P/E fallacy / end of commodity memory short.
x.com/…/2118867457205059673

CYCLE TRACKER · SUPPLY TIGHT; SPLIT TAPE; POLICY RISK STILL ELEVATED

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 6 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	No new contract print; Counterpoint ASP ~$1.9/Gb Q3 carried; street ASP paths via X still elevated	**Rising, slower**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.17 (−0.82%) flat vs No. 31; DDR4 16Gb $80.82 (−1.06%) slightly softer; wafer still $16.15 (−4.33% w/w)	**Flat / softer DDR4**
LTAs / lead times	Jonah: SKH sold through 2029; pequity: limited DC-curb hit; TechInsights 85% / Counterpoint fabs 2028 carried	**Long, firm**
Margins / guide	US Fri rebound (MU +5%, SOX +4%) after Thu rout; Asia Fri FINAL plunge (KOSPI −6%, SKH −10.4%); bounce ≠ cycle turn	**Peak zone**
Capex / new supply	TSMC 3D DRAM plans-only (Nvidia request); YMTC 4th fab 60–70% local tools (no orders); Micron Fab 11E mediation continues	**Building, LT option**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 31, NOV 6)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028 — unchanged on supply fundamentals. Policy/sentiment risk still elevated: Asia Friday FINAL confirms (KOSPI −6.02%, foreigners −₩2.77T); US Friday bounce is not a cycle turn. DRAM spot flat on DDR5 vs No. 31, DDR4 slightly softer. TSMC 3D DRAM at Nvidia's request is a long-dated competitive option (plans only), not near-term supply. Playbook: physical tightness intact; equities still pricing slower DC timing and midterm overhang. Next: Sandisk record Nov 9, TSMC Oct sales + CPI Nov 10, Korea 1–10 exports Nov 11, AMAT Nov 12, Nvidia Nov 17.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 9–20 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Mon Nov 9	Sandisk split record date (8-for-1) · Onto Innovation after the close · Taiwan MOF Oct exports (watch)	NAND
Tue Nov 10	TSMC October sales · US CPI 15:30 · CoreWeave / Infineon after the close	AI
Wed Nov 11	Korea Nov 1–10 exports · US Veterans Day (markets closed)	Trade
Thu Nov 12	Applied Materials after the close · Nebius · Fri: US PPI 15:30	WFE
Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3 results (call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 exhibits Nov 17–19	HBM
Thu Nov 20	Sandisk first split-adjusted trading day (effective after close Nov 19)	NAND

Watch	China GAC October trade still pending (est. Nov 7–10)	Trade

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #32 · Nov 7, 2026